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Mrs Christa Masters MA (Hons) FRTPI
Inspector, Epsom & Ewell Local Plan Examination
By email to the Programme Officer

[ ] August 2026

Dear Madam

Epsom & Ewell Local Plan Examination — cumulative Green Belt change across the historic Horton estate

We write on behalf of Oak Glade Management Limited and Cuddington Glade Management Limited, which together represent the twenty-eight households of the Oak Glade and Cuddington Glade communities off Chertsey Lane, Epsom. We appeared at the hearing session on 2 July 2026.

We are not seeking to introduce new evidence, and we understand from that session that you alone determine what documentation is admitted. This letter concerns the sufficiency of evidence already before the Examination, and it makes a single point.

The point

The historic Horton Hospital estate comprises five former hospital sites extending to 204.29 hectares, every hectare of which is presently designated Metropolitan Green Belt. The Submission Local Plan proposes to remove 82.27 hectares from the Green Belt through revised Major Developed Site inset boundaries. The figures below are the Council's own.

Former hospital site	Site area (ha)	Proposed inset (ha)	Proportion
West Park	34.95	25.60	73.2%
St Ebba's	26.19	16.14	61.6%
Livingstone Park	38.92	14.63	37.6%
Clarendon Park	45.09	12.19	27.0%
Manor Park	59.14	13.71	23.2%
Total	**204.29**	**82.27**	**40.3%**

Source: Epsom & Ewell Borough Council Green Belt evidence base and Submission Local Plan.

HOR001 (approximately 0.52 ha) and HOR004 (approximately 1.11 ha) are additional to that total, and are promoted through site allocation rather than inset revision.

Each of these changes is assessed separately, in separate documents, against separate tests. **We have not been able to identify any published document in which their combined effect is assessed as a single question.**

Why we raise it

We raise it because the Council itself identified the risk. Its site assessment work published in December 2024 concluded that neither HOR001 nor HOR004 demonstrated the exceptional circumstances required for release. It described one site as “rather small”, with “limited benefit from the quantum of development” when weighed against the impact on openness, and warned that both were awkwardly shaped parcels vulnerable to incremental infill — characterising the risk as the “slow ebbing away of small areas of Green Belt”.

That is a description of cumulative erosion, recorded in the Council’s own evidence, in respect of these very sites. We have not been able to identify, in the evidence now before you, either a reaffirmation of that warning or a reasoned explanation of why it no longer applies.

What we have done to check

We have examined the published Green Belt topic papers and their addenda, the Green Belt Study Update, the site assessment material, the Sustainability Appraisal and its addendum, the Habitats Regulations Assessment addendum, and the transport and infrastructure evidence. We have also asked the Council directly, through the Programme Officer, on two occasions in July 2026, to identify where the relevant assessments are recorded. We have received no response identifying that material.

If such an assessment exists and we have simply not found it, we would be glad to be directed to it, and this letter falls away.

Our request

- That the combined effect of the proposed Green Belt changes across the historic Horton estate — the five Major Developed Site inset revisions, together with HOR001 and HOR004 — be assessed and published as a single question before those changes are confirmed.

We are asking for assessment, not for refusal. If the combined effect is acceptable, an assessment will demonstrate it and the Plan will be the stronger for having done the work. If it is not, we would respectfully suggest that this is better established before adoption than afterwards, since Green Belt once released is not recovered.

We recognise that whether the evidence base is proportionate to a change of this scale is a matter of planning judgement for you. Our submission is only that the question should be asked, and that on the material we have been able to examine, it has not been.

Enclosure

We enclose a Planning Evidence Review prepared on behalf of the two companies, and have asked the Programme Officer to place it in the Examination Library. It introduces no new technical evidence: it draws on the Council’s published evidence base, national policy, and official copies of registered title obtained from HM Land Registry, and brings that material together so that the position across the estate can be read in one place. The figures above are set out with their sources at Chapter 5.

We are grateful for your consideration.

Yours faithfully

Julian Downing
On behalf of Oak Glade Management Limited and Cuddington Glade Management Limited